

Usenet Ultimate v1.4.1

Auto-Installers - Self-Host in Seconds.

For those that don't know, Usenet Ultimate is a self-hosted Stremio add-on for streaming Usenet content. It searches indexers (Newznab/Prowlarr/NZBHydra) and EasyNews, sends NZBs to NZBDav for virtual mounting, and streams the resulting video files back through Stremio (or other Stremio add-on supported apps) via a WebDAV proxy or a direct redirect to the WebDAV mounted address.

Usenet Ultimate is the original home of features like Ultimate Fallback, Ultimate Library, Proxy-less WebDAV Streaming Mode, Dedicated Season and Series Pack Support, Smart Mode Health Checking, Auto Indexer Capability Discovery, NZB Databases, Reboot/Remake Detection, NZB Fallback Auto-Resolve, and more!

The GitHub repository for this project is here:

<https://github.com/DSmart33/Usenet-Ultimate>

If you're interested in this project, I would love it if you joined the Discord community here:

<https://discord.gg/6RPVSeq56v>

If you're interested in supporting my development of Usenet Ultimate, you can do so here:

<https://ko-fi.com/dsmart33>

v1.4.1 is a refinement release on top of 1.4.0. It's mostly fixes and hardening, with a few new features mixed in.

As always, thank you to the Usenet Ultimate community and beta testers for making development so much fun!

For those that don't want to know the specifics, here's the TLDR:

Flagship Features:

- **Auto-Installers: one-command scripts to self-host in seconds**
 - **Supports macOS, Linux, and Windows (localhost and LAN/HTTPS)**

- **New Installation, First-Time Setup, and Recommended Settings guides (INSTALLATION.md + SETUP.md)**
- **TVDB & TMDB: Stremio ID prefix support (requires re-install of manifest)**
- **Hardened HTTP Proxy Exit-IP Verification (search/grab account protection)**

Other Features:

- **Bug Fix: Indexer-stats grab counting and case-variant row merge**
- **Bug Fix: TV files filed under the TV category even with Ultimate Fallback off**
- **Bug Fix: DV+HDR filtering and sorting**
- **Ultimate Library folder hygiene and indexer decoy detection**
- **UTS: Prefer TMDB premiere year over theatrical year for movies**
- **VC-1 codec support for filtering and sorting**
- **Bare resolution detection (numbers without the "p" suffix)**
- **Tamtaro v2.5.2 rules preset button**
- **No Ultimate Fallback tile on empty search results**

1) Auto-Installers, Installation, Setup, Recommended Settings

- **Auto-Installers**
 - These scripts automate the Docker Compose setups documented in the new INSTALLATION.md, so you don't have to hand-write compose files, Caddyfiles, etc..
 - **Localhost: Usenet Ultimate + NzbDAV running on a single machine.**
 - `auto-install-localhost-Mac-Linux.sh` (macOS / Linux)
 - `auto-install-localhost-Windows.ps1` (Windows PowerShell)
 - **LAN: adds HTTPS so the addon is reachable from phones, TVs, and other computers on your local wifi network.**
 - `auto-install-LAN-Mac-Linux.sh` (macOS / Linux)
 - `auto-install-LAN-Windows.ps1` (Windows PowerShell)
 - **Every script runs without arguments.**
 - The LAN scripts prompt for your DuckDNS subdomain and token if you don't pass them.
- [INSTALLATION.md](#)

- A full installation guide covering three scenarios: Localhost Only, LAN-Accessible (HTTPS via DuckDNS + Caddy), and Public Internet (with links to the recommended VPS guides).
- Each scenario includes the complete Docker Compose file, prerequisites, and step-by-step commands for Windows, macOS, and Linux. The LAN scenario adds a dedicated troubleshooting section (certificate issuance, DNS-rebind, cellular-vs-LAN behavior, token rotation).
- [SETUP.md](#)
 - A first-run walkthrough that picks up once the stack is running: create your account, set up indexers (Newznab, Prowlarr, NZBHydra2, or EasyNews), add your TMDB and TVDB keys, connect NzbDAV, install the addon in Stremio, and confirm a working stream.
 - Recommended Settings are also included in the second half of this file.
- [README.md](#)
 - A new "Installation and Setup" section links the three guides and the auto-installers, and the Quick Start section now points at them too.

2) TVDB and TMDB: Stremio ID prefix support

- Usenet Ultimate now accepts TVDB and TMDB as an entry point for both movies and series.
- A TVDB/TMDB API key must be configured
- **You must reinstall or reload the manifest to accept these ids as it is a manifest change.**

3) HTTP Proxy Exit-IP Verification Hardening

- IP verification is now per-result.
 - Each result is stamped with a hash of the exit IP that was live when it was fetched.

- That hash stamp is then verified at grab time and aborted unless the IP at grab time matches the hashed stamp.
 - The hash stamp is only applied to the IP address when the before and after search IP's match.
 - If no stamp is present at grab time (the IP rotated during the search), or the stamp doesn't match the live IP at grab time (the IP rotated between search and grab), the grab aborts and a reset clears the search cache, fallback groups, and sessions so the next search re-stamps on the current IP.
- Three locations carry the hash stamp:
 1. The search result is where it's first stamped, during search. This lives in the in-memory search cache.
 2. The stream tile URL carries it as the ip field inside the t envelope.
 3. The fallback group candidates get a copy when the group is built (when UF is enabled).
- Which stamp is used at grab time:
 - UF on + group alive: the group candidate's stamp (the handler matches the clicked/walked candidate to the group by URL+title).
 - UF off, or group expired/cleared/post-restart-without-group: the URL envelope's ip
 - The group candidate is the primary source. The URL ip is the fallback that survives in the player's saved URL when there's no live group.
- Three places perform fan-out reset of stream data (clearing of search cache + fallback groups + UF sessions):
 - Any mismatch of IPs.
 - Keepalive: An every 30s background process that deletes the cached IP and fans out the same three clears, so the user's next search stamps fresh.
 - Config changes: changing proxyMode, proxyUrl, or proxyIndexers clears the proxy agent + search cache + fallback groups + UF sessions together.

- The UI also resets the displayed connection status / exit IP so it doesn't keep showing "Connected, X.X.X.X" for a proxy that's no longer in use.
- Unified HTTP Proxy bypass:
 - Search, verification, and grab use one shared set of bypass rules, so they always agree on whether a request should go through the proxy.
 - Bypass logs now show the host's real (non-proxied) exit IP, so you can see where an opted-out indexer's traffic actually left from.
- **HTTP Proxy is still only recommended for use with Tailscale + Squid.**
 - More details on this can be found in the projects README on github.

4) Bug Fix: Indexer Stats

- Grab tracking has been updated for accurate indexer performance metrics.

5) Bug Fix: TV files filed under the TV category even with Ultimate Fallback off

- Content is correctly categorized no matter the applied settings within Usenet Ultimate. (Ultimate Fallback off)

6) Bug Fix: DV+HDR filtering and sorting

- The filter and sorting of dual hdr releases has been fixed.

6) Ultimate Library folder hygiene and indexer decoy detection

- Decoy Detection

- Hidden files and folders are now skipped during video discovery.
 - Uploaders sometimes plant a hidden .unpack.mkv file or .unpack/ folder as a decoy; these are ignored so the genuine video is picked instead.
- Numbered samples and trailers are now identified.
 - Files like Sample1.mkv, Sample-1.mkv, or Trailer2.mp4 are treated as non-playable, not just the base sample.mkv / trailer.mkv forms.
- Real titles are protected
 - A release whose name legitimately contains "sample" or "trailer" followed by letters is not mistaken for a decoy.
- Folder hygiene
 - Deleting a video removes its leftover folder.
 - Previously, in the uncommon case that a folder still held a sample, .sfv, or .nfo file after the video was deleted, the folder was left behind.
 - This stuck folder caused NzbDAV to drop the next download into a new "Release.Name (1)" folder, which broke playback for that release.
 - Deletion now removes the folder when nothing watchable is left, while keeping packs that still have other episodes.
 - The "is anything watchable left?" check uses the same decoy rules as discovery, so a folder containing only decoys is correctly treated as empty and cleaned up rather than kept alive.
 - A one-time startup cleanup removes pre-existing leftover folders from libraries that already have them.
 - That same pass also clears false "video file not found" dead-NZB marks.
 - When a download had been retried into a "Release.Name (1)" folder, the original NZB was wrongly marked dead even though the content was fine; those entries are cleared so the NZB can be used again instead of being skipped.

7) Ultimate Text Search: Prefer TMDB premiere year over theatrical year for movies

- Scene release groups tag a film with the year IMDB shows, which is the earliest public release (which in some cases is a festival or limited premiere), while TMDB, Cinemeta, and others, report the later wide-theatrical year.
 - When those two differ, a text search built from the theatrical year misses the scene releases, since they're tagged with the premiere year.
- For movies, title resolution now reads TMDB's full release-date list and, when the earliest release is a year before the theatrical date, it uses that premiere year for the search instead.
 - This matches the year IMDB and release groups use, so releases that were previously missed now display.

8) VC-1 codec support for filtering and sorting

- VC-1 is now detected from the release title and appears in Encode Filters & Priorities, so you can filter and rank it like any other codec.
- The new default order places it just below AVC.
- For existing users it's appended to the bottom of your current list (enabled) so custom orders are preserved.

9) Bare resolution detection (numbers without the "p" suffix)

- HD releases that tag resolution without the "p" (e.g. Movie.2160.WEB-DL) used to read as Unknown.
- When the parser and UHD check both miss, a bare 2160/1440/1080/720 is now mapped to 4K/1440p/1080p/720p.

10) Tamtaro v2.5.2 rules preset button

- Ranked Rules Import URL Button:

- A button has been added that fills the URL field with the Tamtaro v2.5.2 template.
- The button grabs the url for v2.5.2 as newer templates aren't currently compatible.

11) No Ultimate Fallback tile on empty search results

- When a search returns 0 results, the Ultimate Fallback tile is no longer displayed at the top of the empty results list.

Migrations:

- VC-1 encode priority
 - For existing users it's appended to the bottom of your current list and enabled so custom orders are preserved.
 - New installs and "Reset to Default" place VC-1 enabled between AVC and VP8.
- Indexer stats hygiene
 - A one-time, config-gated pass merges indexer stat rows that differ only in capitalization and purges a "WebDAV Library" entry left behind by the old grab tracker, correcting the global grab total.
- Ultimate Library leftover folders
 - A one-time, config-gated operation removes leftover release folders (those left stranded by samples/.sfv/.nfo files) from WebDAV libraries that have them.
 - The operations also clears the "video file not found" dead-NZB entries created when a download was retried into a "Release.Name (1)" folder.

Thank you for taking the time to read through the v1.4.1 update!

As always, feel free to ask any questions!